

No More DVDs!

You can make your computer pretend not to have a DVD drive. The following tweak is useful if, say, you have kids at home and you don't want them to play DVDs on the computer. Or, you have a large CD/DVD collection, you're away from home, and you don't want your friends messing with your collection.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\MediaPlayer\Player\Settings

The value name of interest here is EnableDVDUI. It should be a String Value (REG_SZ). Create it if it's not there, or modify it according to what you want. "No" will disable the drive, and "Yes" will enable it.

A reboot is required for the changes to take effect. This hack has been found not to work on some systems, so you'll just have to take pot luck. If it doesn't work, just delete the value (EnableDVDUI) you created!

Reclaim Your Optical Drive

This hack might help if your optical drive isn't being detected. This hack is applicable if your drives disappear after you uninstall Adaptec Easy CD Creator versions 5.01 and earlier, or DirectCD version 3.01 or 3.01c. It should also work if your drives have disappeared for no apparent reason, or after various program installations and/or upgrades. In any case, it doesn't hurt to try it. You'll need to restart to see your drive again—if the hack works, that is.

Navigate to:

HLM\System\CurrentControlSet\Control\Class\{4D36E965-E325-11CE-BFC1-08002BE10318}

Delete the values inside the keys UpperFilters and LowerFilters. If that doesn't seem to work, go ahead and delete the keys themselves. You'll need to reboot to see if you've had any luck after that.